

RICHARD KWAKU OPOKU

Cybersecurity | Cloud Security | Network Security | MSc Applicant

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ACADEMIC PROFILE

Year 3 Computer Science & Engineering student (UMaT, First Class standing - 80.87 CWA) applying to MSc programmes in cybersecurity, cloud security, and network security. Combines formal security training (OMC, Google Cybersecurity, ISC2 CC in progress) with coursework in information security and cryptography, hands-on AWS security labs, and production systems where access control and secure deployment are first-class concerns.

Research interests: cloud security architecture, identity & access management, network defence and monitoring, applied cryptography, secure DevOps / cloud-native hardening, and risk management (NIST CSF).

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science and Engineering

Year 3 - Expected 2027

University of Mines and Technology (UMaT), Tarkwa, Ghana

- CWA: 80.87 (First Class standing)
- Relevant coursework: Cloud Computing, Software Engineering, Database Systems, AI/ML Systems, IoT & Embedded Systems, Information Security
- Security-aligned study: Cryptography, TCP/IP networking, Linux administration, SQL for security analytics, risk assessment, incident response, CIA triad, NIST CSF

ACADEMIC PROJECTS

Cryptography Research & Implementation

Information Security course, UMaT

- Research-led coursework on symmetric and asymmetric encryption with practical implementation (course-based academic project)

TEACHING & LEADERSHIP

Teaching Assistant - C# Programming

Dept. of Computer Science & Engineering, UMaT

- Supported lecture delivery, lab sessions, and student coursework under faculty supervision

Tutor

AAENICS Robotics Club, UMaT

- Mentored members on robotics, embedded systems, and hands-on hardware projects

Hardware Hackathon Organizer

AAENICS / UMaT

- Organized and facilitated hardware-focused hackathons for student teams

CERTIFICATIONS & SECURITY TRAINING

AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner

Amazon Web Services

Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate

Foundations, Risk, Networks, Linux & SQL (4 of 8 courses completed)

OMC Cybersecurity Trainee

One Million Coders

ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity (CC)

In progress

AWS re/Start Graduate

AmaliTech - cloud architecture, IAM, VPC, EC2, S3, Linux, Python, networking, databases

Machine Learning Specialization

Stanford University & DeepLearning.AI (Coursera)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cybersecurity & networking: Linux, Bash, SQL; Wireshark, tcpdump; TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, HTTP/S; firewalls, VPNs, network hardening; cryptography; CIA triad, NIST CSF, risk assessment, incident response planning

Cloud security: AWS (IAM, S3 policy hardening, Lambda execution roles, API Gateway, Amplify, EC2, VPC); least-privilege access; block public access; CI/CD pipeline security

Software (supporting): C#, Python, Node.js, TypeScript, React/Next.js, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Docker, Git

SECURITY & CLOUD EXPERIENCE

AWS Hands-On Security Labs

Personal AWS account (us-west-1) - documented on LinkedIn

- Lab 1 - Secure CI/CD: Amplify Hosting + GitHub; HTTPS portfolio deploy
- Lab 2 - Storage security: S3 block public access; least-privilege IAM scoped to private/ prefix
- Lab 3 - Serverless API: Lambda + API Gateway with dedicated IAM execution role

Cybersecurity Trainee

OMC / One Million Coders

- Structured programme covering cybersecurity fundamentals, threat landscape, and practical security concepts

SECURITY-RELEVANT PROJECTS

Quads - Campus marketplace

quadsmarket.tech

- RBAC (buyer/seller/admin), Paystack escrow, API on AWS EC2 behind Cloudflare, MongoDB Atlas

Scholar - AI scholarship platform

schorla.vercel.app

- Document ingestion for CVs, transcripts, SOPs; Supabase auth and access control for sensitive data

UMaTBOT (MINEBOT) - Campus helpdesk

Telegram Bot, Python

- Automated FAQ and resource delivery with controlled bot access patterns

InsightFlow, StudyMate, Sheet2SaaS

Shipped SaaS products

- Auth, database security, and production deployment (Vercel/Supabase/PostgreSQL)

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

IoT Hackathon Developer

Robotics Club (AAENICS), UMaT - 2026

- ESP32 + MQTT embedded prototypes; team-based automation challenge with panel evaluation

Hackathon Participant

Dept. of Computer Science & Engineering, UMaT - 2025

- Collaborative software solution design and presentation